

not simply minimise the RF number. You will just be wasting resources by doing so. Reducing the quality, or increasing the RF number beyond a certain point however, will result in a visible loss in quality. For most videos, the slider should be kept between 20 to 23, even though it goes all the way from 0 to 51. Click on Start Encode to begin the operation, grab a cup of coffee, sit back and let the magic happen.

## Preview a transcode

Now, if you have used typical high quality panel discussion footage for the previous operation, you would have noticed that you would have gone through multiple cups of coffee. This is because transcoding is a processor intensive task, and it takes a lot of time. Wouldn't it be great if Handbrake would allow you to encode a tiny section of the video, just to see what the quality would look like, before committing to transcoding the entire thing? Well, Handbrake does indeed do just that. Once you have loaded a video, and adjusted all the settings as per the requirements, click on the Preview button. You can now adjust some additional settings specific to the preview render. The most important here is the duration, which goes from 5 seconds up to 4 minutes. Click on Live Preview to begin the transcoding. At the end of the process, the video is automatically loaded on your default video player, whether or not you check the option to use the default video player, so we are not really sure exactly why that option exists. If you find out, do let us know.

## Partially transcode a video

Now, you might want to save only a portion of the video, and Handbrake allows you to do that. Note that you cannot make complex edits such as cut out multiple portions of a single video, or string together many video files into a single output. The only option is to transcode a video from point A to point B. Now, these points can either be specified in time, or by the actual frame. Next to titles, in range, there are these two options. Now Handbrake itself does not allow you to scrub through a video to identify the time, nor the frame. In fact, there is no timeline on the GUI. How you figure out the frame or the time where you want to transcode is entirely left to you. Once you have the information though, you can feed it into Handbrake, and the software will only transcode that section of the selected video. Note that you do not need to worry about keyframes here, as Handbrake is a transcoding software. If the start point is not on